Payson's Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Turdas, the 29th of Frostfall (Thursday, October 29, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 29 · Price: One Septim



Gandy dozes on the deck under the grey skies while Maevy bats at a falling pine leaf.

Skies o'er the Hold 70° / 49° Overcast

A grey, mild day — overcast skies, a steady breeze, and a chance of rain.

Wind 11 mph · Feels like 64° · UV 4 (Moderate) · Rain 2%

Sunrise 6:42 AM · Sunset 5:34 PM · Tomorrow — Rain, 64/48

The Moon's Reckoning

Yesterday · Tonight (Waning Gibbous) · Tomorrow

waning toward the new moon

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
59° Overcast, 5 mph	68° Overcast, 11 mph	66° Overcast, 4 mph	55° Overcast, 6 mph

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Halloween Eve-Eve Brings Markets, Music, and a New Shop for the Hold



Payson, Ariz.

Listen to this story



Pumpkins, small knights, and merry riders — Halloween week stands merry across the Holds.

Well met, wayfarer, and a mild Turdas morning to you — grey clouds ride easy over the Rim, the pines stand still and green, and Mogollon's Hearth lifts a mug to you under an overcast sky.

PAYSON — The Payson Hold itself rests quiet today, and the merriment rides abroad: a creekside farmers market in Cornville this afternoon, fly-fishing talk near Show Low, and piano music and tai chi in Prescott. Then the week turns full Halloween — a brand-new gravel bike race rolls into Prescott on Friday, Oct. 30, and trunk-or-treats light up Camp Verde, Sedona, and Show Low on Saturday, Oct. 31. And the week's crown rides on Sunday, Nov. 1, when a brand-new TJ Maxx throws open its doors right here in Payson. By the Nine, there is plenty here to fill a guest's day before the rain the weather-wise promise for tomorrow.

Happening in the Holds Today

Listen to this story

- **Camp Verde**

  — **Windmill Park Farmers Market** — today from 2 to 6 in the afternoon at Windmill Park, 9950 East Cornville Road in Cornville, just outside Camp Verde. A small-town creekside market, rain or shine — fresh produce, sourdough and baked goods, farm eggs, local honey, goat-milk soaps, jams, pickles, and handmade crafts from local makers. It is a fine guest outing for anyone who shops with their stomach. Come hungry, and bring a bag with room to spare.

- **Show Low**

  — **White Mountain Fly Fishing with Jim Goughnour** — tonight at 5:30 at 425 South Woodland Road in Pinetop-Lakeside, just south of Show Low, with Arizona Game and Fish and Wildlife for Tomorrow. An evening of fly-fishing talk for the White Mountains — where the fish rise, how the high-country waters fish, and what a beginner needs to start. Anglers and the merely curious are both welcome. A splendid reason for a short evening ride up the mountain.

- **Prescott**

  — **Tai Chi with Larry — The 42 Combination Form** — today at 4 in the afternoon at The Center on Rosser, 1280 East Rosser Street, Suite B, in Prescott. A guided tai chi session working the 42 Combination Form — slow, steady movement that suits beginners and old hands alike. Wear loose clothes and soft shoes, and settle into the calm. A gentle way to spend a grey afternoon before supper.

  — **Spare Keys Piano Duo at Whiskey and Ivory** — tonight at 5 in Prescott. Two pianists, one merry evening of live keys — the kind of small-room music where every table sits close to the song. Arrive early for a good seat, order something warm, and let the duo carry the evening. Music lovers riding over from the Hearth will find it worth the road.

  — **Thursday Social Run** — tonight at 5:30 at Mile High Beer Project in Prescott. A friendly group run on a Thursday night — runners of every pace gather, head out together, and come back to good company. First-timers are honored guests, not stragglers. Bring your running shoes and your best stories from the trail.

The Days Ahead

Listen to this story

- **Fri, Oct. 30**

  — **Prescott — The Rough Rider** opens at Courthouse Square in Prescott, a brand-new three-day gravel bike race running Friday, Oct. 30 through Sunday, Nov. 1. Riders take on three stages of high-desert roads based in historic downtown — Stage 1 starts Friday at 9 in the morning at Camp Wood, and the weekend stages finish right on North Cortez Street. Spectators get the best of it: fast starts, dusty finishes, and a square full of food and cheer. Come wave the riders home like bards greeting heroes.

- **Sat, Oct. 31**

  — **Morning Café on Zoom** — Saturday at 9:30 in the morning, from Unity of Payson at 110 East Bonita Street, joined by Zoom. An inspirational start to Halloween day — good words, friendly faces, and an unhurried hour before the costumes come out. Join from the Hearth with a mug in hand; the link stands on the church's own page. A warm, quiet counterpoint to the night's merry noise.

  — **Camp Verde Trunk or Treat** takes over Main Street in Camp Verde from 5 to 7 in the evening. Businesses, groups, and neighbors line the street with decorated cars and booths, handing out candy to crowds the town counts in the thousands. There are haunted houses, games, music, and a Haunted Jail for the brave, plus a decorating contest. Costumes are the order of the night — bring a bag with room to spare.

  — **Uptown Trick or Treat** in Sedona, 5 to 8 in the evening along Uptown's main street on State Route 89A. Shops stay open late handing out candy as costumed families wander door to door under the red rocks. Look for the "Thriller" flash-mob dance at Sinagua Plaza and the Fire Department's Haunted Ambulance nearby. It is Sedona's biggest Halloween gathering — joyful, glowing, and full of tiny dragons and knights.

  — **Show Low Main Street Trunk or Treat** — from 3 to 8 in the evening at Hatch Toyota, 1051 North Auto Mall Parkway in Show Low. Trunk-or-treating, music, food, a haunted house, and a Kids Zone, with a trunk-decorating contest offering cash prizes. Presented by Show Low Main Street, it is the town's main Halloween gathering. Families from across the White Mountains make the trip for this one.

- **Sun, Nov. 1**

  — **TJ Maxx Grand Opening** — Payson's own brand-new TJ Maxx throws open its doors Sunday, Nov. 1, at 400 East State Highway 260, with opening-day hours from 8 in the morning to 8 at night. Off-price treasures are the house specialty — clothes, shoes, home goods, and gifts at prices to make a bard sing. Arrive early for the best pick of the racks; the whole Hold has waited for this one, and Sunday is the day to be first through the door.

  — **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — Sunday from 8 in the morning to noon at 2201 West State Route 89A in Sedona. Local growers and makers spread their tables under the red rocks — produce, baked goods, and handmade wares for a slow Sunday morning. Go early for the best pick of the bread. Valley Dwellers riding home can stock the pantry on the way. A fine close to Halloween weekend.

- **Tue, Nov. 3**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine** — from 7 in the morning to noon, off Highway 87 just before Pine. Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to help clear brush, move rocks, and shape a trail the whole community will use for years. The work also opens better access for fire crews, so every hour given does double duty. Tools are provided and no experience is needed — bring water, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes, and sign up at trails@psfuelreduction.org.

- **Wed, Nov. 4**

  — **Bible Study at Juanita's** — Wednesday at 9 in the morning at 139 Hash Knife Drive in Payson. A small, weekly, come-as-you-are study group, warm and unhurried — a quiet, friendly local morning rather than a big event. Guests who like to start a day in good company will feel right at home. No fuss, no fanfare — just neighbors and an open door.

  — **Musicians with Heart Open Mic** — Wednesday night at 7 at the Jersey Lilly Saloon in Prescott. Local singers and pickers take their turns in a Whiskey Row saloon while the crowd settles in — and every donation goes to local charity. Part concert, part town gathering with better tunes. Drop in for one song or stay for the whole merry evening.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torch sconces, and the doors wait their turn on the workshop bench.

- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Print two torches plus the socket test piece, and test-fit the bulb and socket first.
- ☐ **Design and prep the torch sconces** — Scale the sconce model to the flame bulb, slice in PETG, and check the door-light wiring.
- ☐ **Finish and install the torches** — Paint, seal against the sun, wire into the door-light boxes with the breaker off, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Laser-cut layered plywood, 3D-print the troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, where the walkway sees it best.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — The front and side door work that ties the shield and torches together.

All six quests stand ready — the torch sconces and the Hearth shield have waited longest, so the workshop calls their names first.

Merchant of the Hold

Listen to this story

Layla’s Bakery-Cafe · *Sedona*



Inside Layla’s, where the almond croissants are praised from Sedona to the Rim.

A whole-grain bakery in West Sedona working in the European way — scratch-made pastries, eclairs, cakes, and sourdough loaves baked daily, plus a small seasonal breakfast-and-lunch menu and a full espresso bar, opened in April 2018 by pastry chef Javier Franco and Amy Franco. By a kind kitchen-magic, every grain in the house seems to rise twice as proud. Their signature stop is the almond croissant travelers talk about all the way home — or the hard-to-find Kouign Amann with a tiramisu latte on the dog-friendly patio.

> *“We enjoyed the very best almond croissant of our lives here!”* — TripAdvisor review

3190 West Highway 89A, Suite 200, Sedona. Open Tuesday to Saturday 8 to 3, Sunday 8 to 2, closed Monday — so open today, Thursday, Oct. 29, 8 to 3. Phone 928-282-4798. Prices are moderate. Good to know: go early — the pastries sell fast and can be gone by mid-morning, and the outdoor patio welcomes dogs. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a ‘website’)

Why the Hearth sends you: Real trail fuel with a touch of Paris — whole-grain pastries and strong espresso in West Sedona, right on the road toward the red rock trailheads, to eat on the patio or carry up the canyon.

Tales from the Treeline

Listen to this story

The Paper Bat Mix-Up



Mabel hangs, Flurry frosts, and Henny sits on the count.

Turdas dawned grey and mild, so Mabel (a wood elf) set out to hang paper bats along the Hearth porch beam for Halloween — a string of them, each one cut neat and even, in a row any jarl would approve.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) helpfully frosted each knot so the strings would hold stiff in the breeze, and landed proud beside the crate. Henny (the Hearth’s chicken) climbed into that crate, sat down square on the spare bats, and arranged herself like a queen on a paper throne.

Every bat Mabel hung, Henny counted with one solemn cluck — and every count came out one short, because the bat under Henny never got hung at all. At last Mabel sighed her professional sigh, cut one extra bat, and hung it right over Henny’s crate. Henny wears the honor like a banner, and tells the porch she is the best bat of the whole row.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Turdas be free of giants, the admin.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com